

**DIVINE MERCY SUNDAY 2025
GROUP and BUS REGISTRATION
FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS- REGISTRATION**

Thank you for your interest in bringing a group/bus to join us in celebrating Divine Mercy Sunday!

Important Note re: Limits on the Number of Buses allowed per Parish/Group

Each group/parish will be permitted to register SIX buses maximum.

What is the registration period?

You may register your bus from **Monday January 6, 2025** through **Friday, April 4, 2025**.

(1) How do we register our bus?

ALL registrations will be completed online this year. Please ask someone to assist you, if you are not comfortable online. The form is very simple, but we are not staffed to take registrations over the phone; accuracy is improved by you inputting the information. Please read through these pages as many issues can be avoided by following these instructions.

To register: go to our website at: ***ShrineofDivineMercy.org***. On the Home Page: Click on the banner that says “Divine Mercy Sunday”. Thank you in advance for your donation, if you are able to make one. Your bus offering/donation of **\$150 per bus/per weekend** will assist us greatly in defraying the operating expenses for this event and continues to provide all the services for the weekend for our visitors. Thank you for your continued support of the National Shrine of The Divine Mercy!

NEW FOR 2025: All registrations are REQUIRED to provide (1) accurate contact information for the bus company, in the registration, and (2) provide a name and call phone number for a person on ***each*** bus you register. Your place will NOT be saved until each person has replied to a text from us. If you do not fill this in correctly, your bus permit will NOT be mailed, as otherwise, we will have no way to contact you all in case of an emergency!

(2) How can we secure our bus spot?

Please complete the form ONLINE to secure your spot. Please double-check your *email*, and the “*Shipping Address*.” The Shipping Address is WHERE YOU WANT YOUR BUS PARKING PASS, LABELS and INFORMATION to be mailed. We do not have enough packets to send duplicates to multiple addresses. **Note:** You can have a different address for where you want your bus parking permit and information sent than the Credit Card billing address!

(3) Can we call in our registration?

We are ***not*** taking any registrations over the phone, this year. Please go ONLINE and register. An automatic confirmation notice will pop up as soon as you are registered and you will receive an email from our Customer Service Department a few days later, so you will know that your bus is pre-registered, ***PENDING YOUR TEXT REPLIES***. Once your text replies have been confirmed, you will receive your Bus packet. **Please place your parking pass packet in a safe place.**

(4) What if I don't have Internet access?

Please ask someone else in your family or group, or from your parish office, to assist you! Public libraries also often provide free Internet service. The Internet provides us with the fastest and most secure way to register buses. We are not staffed to take registrations over the phone.

(5) May we register after the deadline of April 4th?

The reason we request that you register by April 4th, is so we are able to mail your documents to you to receive them in time! If there is an emergency, please email or call the Shrine Pilgrimage Office. We may be able to register you after April 4th, but may require you to pay for overnight mail delivery, to be sure you have your parking pass in time. **Please be sure to have an address where you can receive next day mail.**

(6) How long after we register do we receive our documents?

We will begin mailing packets by the end of March. Please wait THREE WEEKS FOR YOUR PACKAGE TO ARRIVE before you contact us, as many packages seem to take that long.

If you register before April 4th and you have not received your parcel by April 18, please email Pilgrims@Marian.org immediately.

(7) What should I expect to receive in the mail?

When you receive your packet, please open it immediately. There are several documents:

- a. Check that you have everything (See the list below)
- b. Carefully read through each document
- c. NOTE: There is information you need to share with your Bus Company in advance! *NOTE:* There is information about weather, clothing etc., and preparing for Divine Mercy Sunday that you will want to share with your group BEFORE they get on the bus!
- d. Place it in a safe location
- e. Email Pilgrims@Marian.org any questions as soon as possible, so that we are not overwhelmed at the last minute.

In the packet are:

1. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)
2. Important ways for everyone in your group to prepare for their pilgrimage
3. A (numbered) Bus Parking Permit
4. Important instructions for your bus driver!
5. A set of name badges for the members of your group, pre-printed with your bus number. These are a huge help to our volunteers, so that we can help locate you and/or your bus in the event someone gets lost.

(8) Is there a place to stay on Eden Hill?

No, there is no housing available onsite during the Divine Mercy Sunday timeframe. To check on lodging availability in the area, please go to the Stockbridge Chamber of Commerce at: stockbridgechamber.org

(9) If you have additional questions or concerns

Please check our website first, to be sure that your question is not answered there and if it is not, then email: ***Pilgrims@Marian.org***. Email is the fastest way to get a response during this busy time.

If you cannot email, you may call and leave a voice message at **(413)-298-1119**, but there may be a delay in getting back to you. Please do not call back and leave a second voicemail, as that will only delay our getting back to you and others. And please be sure to let us know the question you need answered.

When leaving a voicemail please say your phone number slowly and clearly. Please leave the time that is best to reach you.